

Shepherd's Path

Complete Environment & Dependency Audit

Confidential — Internal Documentation

Generated: April 30, 2026

shepherddspathai.com | App Store ID: 6760953522 | Bundle: com.shepherddspath.app

Variable	Required	File / Feature	Purpose
DATABASE_URL	REQUIRED	db.ts	PostgreSQL connection string. App will not start without it.
PORT	REQUIRED	index.ts	HTTP port the server listens on.
OPENAI_API_KEY	REQUIRED	faithResponse.ts, routes.ts, smsScheduler.ts	Direct OpenAI key — spiritual guidance AI, TTS, SMS content generation.
AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_API_KEY	REQUIRED*	replit_integrations/*	Replit-proxied OpenAI key. Replace with OPENAI_API_KEY outside Replit.
AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_BASE_URL	REQUIRED*	replit_integrations/*	Replit AI proxy URL. Replace with https://api.openai.com/v1 outside Replit.
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Stripe server-side key for checkout sessions and subscriptions.
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Stripe webhook signature verification.
RESEND_API_KEY	REQUIRED	resend.ts	Sends transactional emails (devotionals, welcome, notifications).
ADMIN_PASSWORD	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Password for admin-protected API routes.
YOUTUBE_API_KEY	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Sermon search via YouTube Data API v3.
UNSPLASH_ACCESS_KEY	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Background images for devotionals and journal entries.
PEXELS_API_KEY	REQUIRED	routes.ts	Fallback image source when Unsplash fails.

Optional Variables

VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY	Optional	pushScheduler.ts, routes.ts	Web push notifications public key. Push disabled if missing.
VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY	Optional	pushScheduler.ts, routes.ts	Web push notifications private key.
VAPID_SUBJECT	Optional	pushScheduler.ts	Email for VAPID subject. Defaults to mailto:admin@shepherdspathAI.com
TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID	Optional	smsScheduler.ts	Twilio account SID for SMS devotionals. SMS disabled if missing.
TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN	Optional	smsScheduler.ts	Twilio auth token.
TWILIO_PHONE_NUMBER	Optional	smsScheduler.ts	From-number for outbound SMS messages.
RESEND_FROM_EMAIL	Optional	resend.ts	Sender email. Defaults to onboarding@resend.dev
APP_URL	Optional	emailScheduler.ts	Used for unsubscribe links in emails. Falls back to REPLIT_DOMAINS.
GOOGLE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON	Optional	routes.ts	Google Play billing verification (Android). Skipped if missing.
ANDROID_SHA256_CERT	Optional	routes.ts	Android TWA cert fingerprint.
ANDROID_PACKAGE_NAME	Optional	routes.ts	Android package name. Defaults to com.shepherdspath.app
PROMO_CODES	Optional	routes.ts	Comma-separated promo codes for Pro access bypass.
ADMIN_BYPASS	Optional	routes.ts	Bypass value for admin auth (debug/testing only).
LOG_LEVEL	Optional	logger.ts	Logging verbosity. Defaults to "info".
NODE_ENV	Optional	logger.ts	"production" enables production logging format.

These are Expo public variables — they are bundled into the app at build time via eas.json and are visible in the client bundle.

Variable	Required	File	Purpose
EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_IOS_API_KEY	REQUIRED	lib/revenuecat.tsx	RevenueCat iOS public API key. App crashes on launch if missing.
EXPO_PUBLIC_API_URL	Optional	lib/api.ts	API base URL. Defaults to https://www.shepherdspathai.com
EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_ANDROID_API_KEY	Optional	lib/revenuecat.tsx	RevenueCat Android key (Android builds only).
EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_TEST_API_KEY	Optional	lib/revenuecat.tsx	RevenueCat sandbox key for dev/testing builds.

The web client uses Vite — most variables are built-in and auto-injected. No manual env setup needed for the web client.

Variable	Required	File	Purpose
BASE_URL (Vite built-in)	Auto	App.tsx	Base path for the web app. Vite injects this automatically.
PROD (Vite built-in)	Auto	main.tsx	Vite production flag — enables service worker registration.

& These variables only exist inside Replit. Outside Replit they will be undefined. The code has fallbacks, but you must configure the replacements.

Replit Variable	What It Does	How To Replace
AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_API_KEY	Replit-proxied OpenAI key	Use your own OPENAI_API_KEY from platform.openai.com
AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_BASE_URL	Replit AI proxy endpoint	Set to https://api.openai.com/v1
REPLIT_CONNECTORS_HOSTNAME	Replit connector routing for Resend/Sheets	Set RESEND_API_KEY directly — code falls back to it automatically
REPL_IDENTITY	Replit auth token for connector services	Not needed outside Replit — leave unset, connector code is bypassed
WEB_REPL_RENEWAL	Replit deployment token	Not needed outside Replit
REPLIT_DOMAINS	Auto-set to your .replit.app domain	Set APP_URL to your own domain (e.g. shepherdspathai.com)
REPLIT_DEPLOYMENT	Signals deployed vs dev environment	Set NODE_ENV=production instead
Database (auto-provisioned)	Replit auto-provisions PostgreSQL	Provision your own Postgres: Railway, Supabase, Neon, or Fly.io

Service	Purpose	Credentials Needed
PostgreSQL	All user data — sessions, streaks, journals,	DATABASE_URL (connection string)
OpenAI	pray wall, subscriptions, sermons Spiritual guidance AI, TTS voice, sermon	OPENAI_API_KEY
Stripe	Web subscriptions, one-time tips, Pro plan	STRIPE_SECRET_KEY, STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET
RevenueCat	iOS in-app purchases via App Store checkout	EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_IOS_API_KEY
Resend	Transactional email — daily devotionals,	RESEND_API_KEY, RESEND_FROM_EMAIL
YouTube Data API v3	welcome notifications Sermon search by scripture reference or topic	YOUTUBE_API_KEY
Unsplash API	Devotional and journal background images	UNSPLASH_ACCESS_KEY
Pexels API	Fallback image source when Unsplash fails	PEXELS_API_KEY
Twilio (optional)	SMS devotional delivery feature	TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID, TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN, TWILIO_PHONE_NUMBER
Web Push / VAPID	Browser and PWA push notifications	VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY, VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY
Google Play Billing	Android purchase verification (optional)	GOOGLE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON
EAS / Expo Application Services	iOS app builds and App Store submission	EXPO_TOKEN, ASC_API_KEY_CONTENT, ASC_KEY_ID, ASC_ISSUER_ID
Apple App Store Connect	iOS app distribution	Apple Developer account + API key credentials

These must exist before you deploy anything. Get credentials ready.

- & Create PostgreSQL database — Railway, Supabase, Neon, or Fly.io. Copy DATABASE_URL.
- & Create OpenAI API key at platform.openai.com !' OPENAI_API_KEY
- & Create Stripe account. Get secret key + set up webhook endpoint !' STRIPE_SECRET_KEY, STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET
- & Create Resend account. Verify your domain. Get API key !' RESEND_API_KEY
- & Create RevenueCat project. Link App Store app. Copy iOS public key !' EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_IOS_API_KEY
- & Enable YouTube Data API v3 in Google Cloud Console !' YOUTUBE_API_KEY
- & Create Unsplash developer app at unsplash.com/developers !' UNSPLASH_ACCESS_KEY
- & Create Pexels API key at pexels.com/api !' PEXELS_API_KEY
- & Generate VAPID keys: npx web-push generate-vapid-keys !' VAPID_PUBLIC_KEY, VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY

Phase 2 — Deploy the API Server

- & Clone repository from GitHub
- & Set all server env vars in your hosting platform (Railway, Render, Fly.io, etc.)
- & Run database migrations: pnpm --filter @workspace/db run push
- & Deploy artifacts/api-server (Node.js / Express server)
- & Verify: GET /api/healthz returns 200
- & Verify: GET /api/daily-art returns a verse with image
- & *Critical: Replace AI_INTEGRATIONS_* vars with OPENAI_API_KEY pointing to api.openai.com/v1*

Phase 3 — Deploy the Web App

- & Deploy artifacts/shepherds-path (Vite/React static site)
- & Serve it at the same domain as the API server, or configure CORS properly
- & Verify: Web app loads and bottom nav (For You / Guidance / Journey / Journal) works
- & Verify: /guidance AI chat gets a response
- & *Critical: Web client uses relative URLs (/api/...) — both must be behind the same domain or a reverse proxy.*

Phase 4 — Build & Submit the iOS App

- & Install EAS CLI: npm install -g eas-cli
- & Log in to Expo: npx eas-cli login
- & Set EXPO_TOKEN, ASC_API_KEY_CONTENT, ASC_KEY_ID, ASC_ISSUER_ID in CI/environment
- & Build: npx eas-cli build --platform ios --profile production
- & Submit: npx eas-cli submit --platform ios --id <build-id>
- & Wait for Apple review (24–48 hours)

Phase 5 — Final Verification

- & GET /api/healthz returns 200
- & GET /api/daily-art returns verse + image
- & Guidance page AI chat responds with scripture-based answer
- & Stripe checkout session creates (test mode first)
- & Email sends from Resend (check spam folder on first send)
- & RevenueCat purchases work in TestFlight before App Store release
- & Push notification text fires successfully

Risk	Solution
Replit AI proxy vars left in place	Set AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_API_KEY = your OPENAI_API_KEY and BASE_URL = https://api.openai.com/v1
Missing DATABASE_URL	Server throws immediately on startup — provision DB first
Stripe webhook secret wrong	Subscription events will silently fail — test with Stripe CLI
APP_URL not set	Email unsubscribe links will break — set to https://shepherdspathai.com

CORS misconfiguration

Web app API calls blocked — serve both from same domain or set CORS headers



RevenueCat key missing

App crashes on launch — EXPO_PUBLIC_REVENUECAT_IOS_API_KEY is required

EAS build quota exhausted

Builds fail silently — quota resets monthly on EAS free plan

Apple credentials expired

Build succeeds but submit fails — check cert expiry in App Store Connect

